How an engagement runs

A one-day board briefing and a year-long fractional role run the same arc, at different speeds.

Read the system	Name what's true	Set the direction	Lead the change	Leave it capable
Days to weeks	One session	1–2 weeks	Ongoing	Final 1–2 weeks

Every phase draws on the same base: 39 years across 20+ sectors, working at both ends of the problem. The outside judgement of non-executive and advisory roles, and the inside delivery of fractional and interim leadership. What changes phase to phase is which lens is doing the work.

01

Read the system

Before any recommendation, the real constraints need to be visible: not the org chart, but how decisions actually get made and what's already been tried. Stakeholder conversations across the business, technology and the board, a review of existing strategy, and a diagnostic that maps dependencies rather than assuming them.

02

Name what's true

The findings go to the board or founder directly, including the parts that are uncomfortable. No softened language, no burying the real risk in a longer list of minor ones. The evidence is structured into the few things that actually matter, and put in front of the people who need to hear them.

03

Set the direction

Direction only means something once it has been tested against what the organisation can actually deliver. The assessment becomes a plan: priorities in order, resourcing made explicit, and a sequence built on real capacity rather than an ideal timeline.

04

Lead the change

This is where most technology advice fails: the plan is handed over and the advisor leaves. Here the leadership continues, embedded in the organisation, making the calls, adjusting the plan as reality intervenes, and carrying accountability for the outcome rather than the recommendation.

05

Leave it capable

The engagement ends by design, not by attrition. Decisions, rationale and context are documented and handed back deliberately, so the work doesn't quietly need me again next year. This is what separates fractional leadership from consultancy dependency.

One conversation.

No obligation. The right fit matters more than the right brochure.

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nc@neilcatton.com · www.neilcatton.com/services.html